

Grid Setup Checklist

Architecture Portfolio Studio · Class 05 · Kent State University

Check off each item as you complete it in class. Every number here should divide evenly by twelve.

1 · Document Size

- ☐ Units set to Points (Preferences > Units & Increments)
- ☐ New document created: Width 600 pt, Height 840 pt, Facing Pages on
- ☐ Checked by hand: $840 / 12 = 70$, no remainder

2 · Margins

- ☐ Top margin set to 36 pt (12 x 3)
- ☐ Bottom margin set to 48 pt (12 x 4)
- ☐ Inside/Outside margins set to 36 pt (12 x 3)

3 · Baseline Grid

- ☐ Preferences > Grids: Start set to 0 pt
- ☐ Relative To set to Top Margin
- ☐ Increment Every set to 12 pt
- ☐ View Threshold changed to 25% (so the grid stays visible while working)
- ☐ View > Grids & Guides > Show Baseline Grid turned on

4 · Row Math, Checked Before Create Guides

- ☐ Content height calculated: $840 - 36 - 48 = 756$ pt
- ☐ Divided by the baseline increment: $756 / 12 = 63$, no remainder
- ☐ Confirmed the fit: $(8 \text{ rows} \times 7 \text{ lines}) + (7 \text{ gutters} \times 1 \text{ line}) = 63$

5 · Create the Guides

- ☐ Layout > Create Guides opened
- ☐ Rows: 8, Gutter: 12 pt
- ☐ Columns: 6, Gutter: 12 pt
- ☐ Fit Guides to: Margins selected (not Page)
- ☐ Baseline grid checked against every row line, no exceptions

6 · Paragraph Styles (real project file only)

- ☐ Paragraph Styles panel opened (Window > Styles > Paragraph Styles)
- ☐ Body Text style opened, Indents and Spacing
- ☐ Align to Grid set to All Lines
- ☐ Confirmed lines of Body Text visibly lock to the baseline grid

This file uses 600 x 840pt to keep the math clean while you learn the system, not because it is a real paper size. If you are printing your final portfolio, see this week's reading, "Every Number in the Grid," for the 612 x 792pt version.